

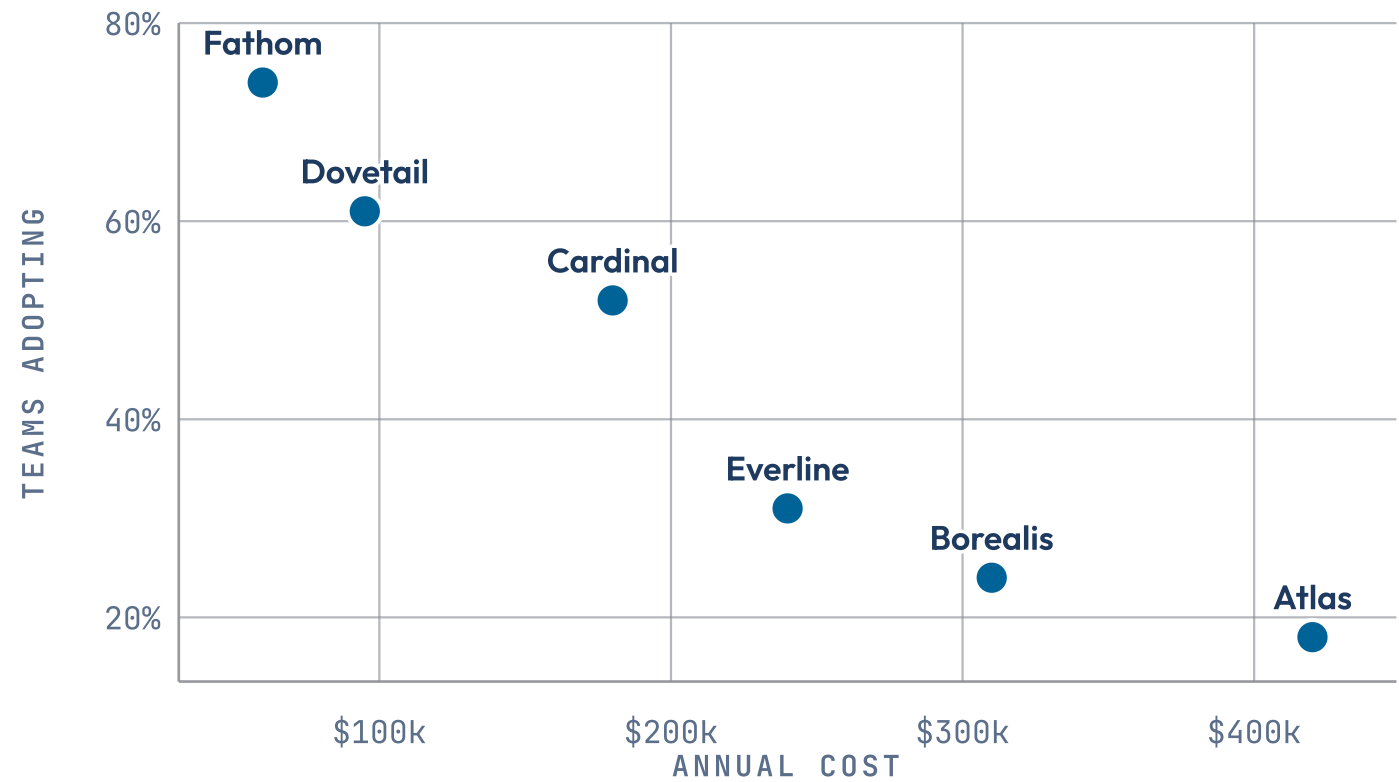
EVIDENCE · CANVAS · SERIES

scatter

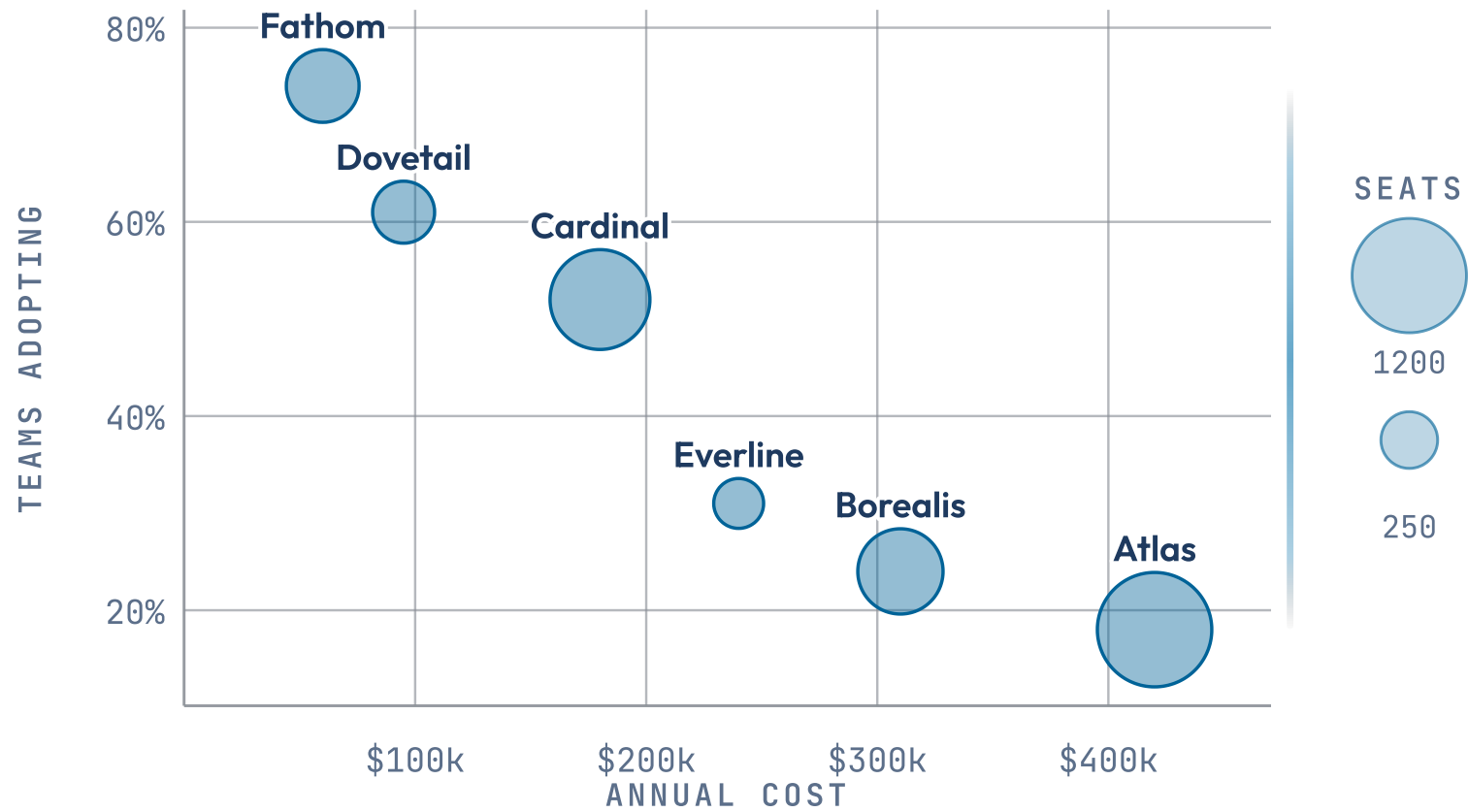
An XY plot with real units on both axes — one dot per entity, showing how two measures relate.

The tools we pay most for are the ones nobody adopts.

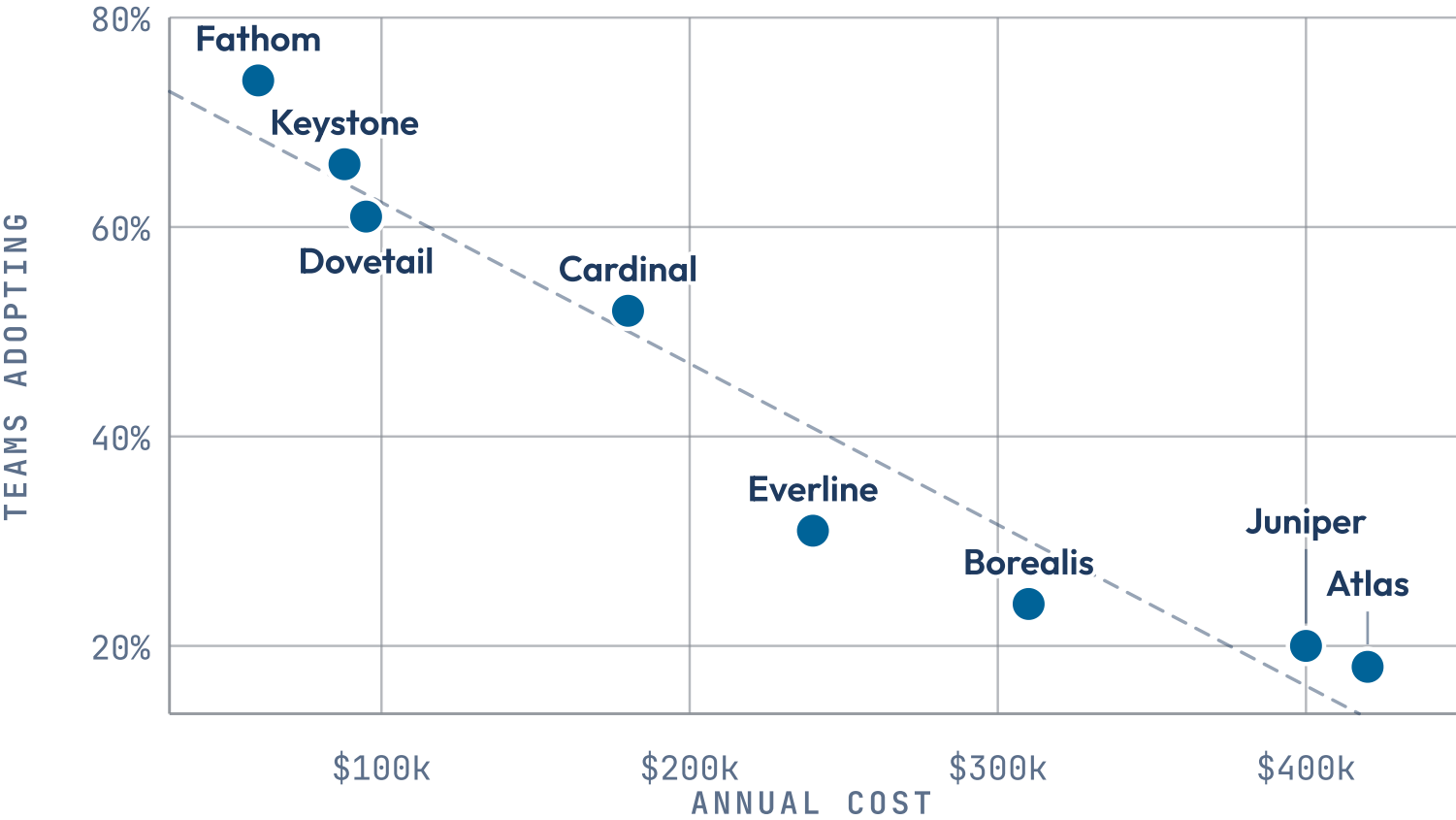
Cost is the renewal we signed; adoption is the share of teams with a weekly active user.



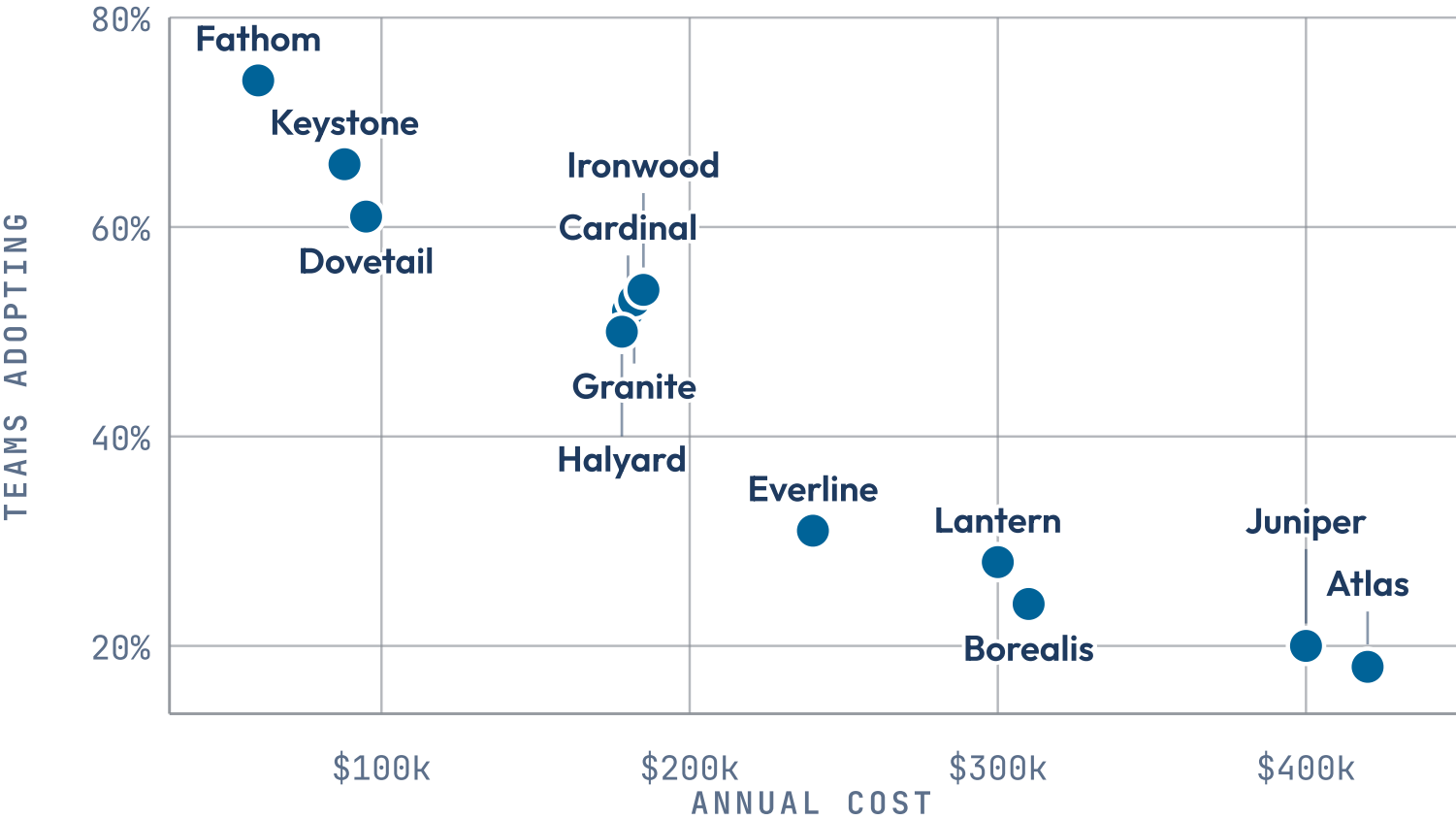
bubble sizes each dot by a third measure.



trend draws the least-squares line through the cloud.

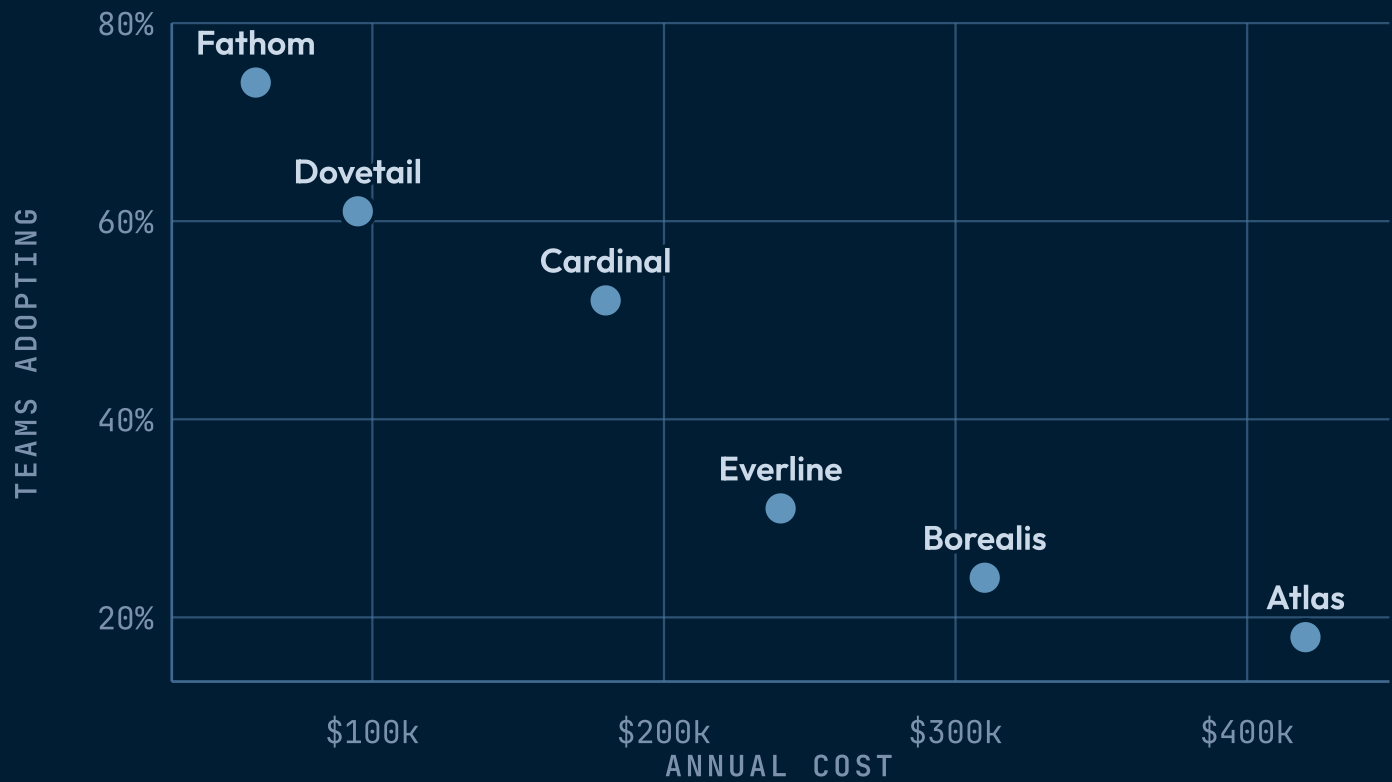


Stress test — twelve tools and a cluster the eye cannot separate.



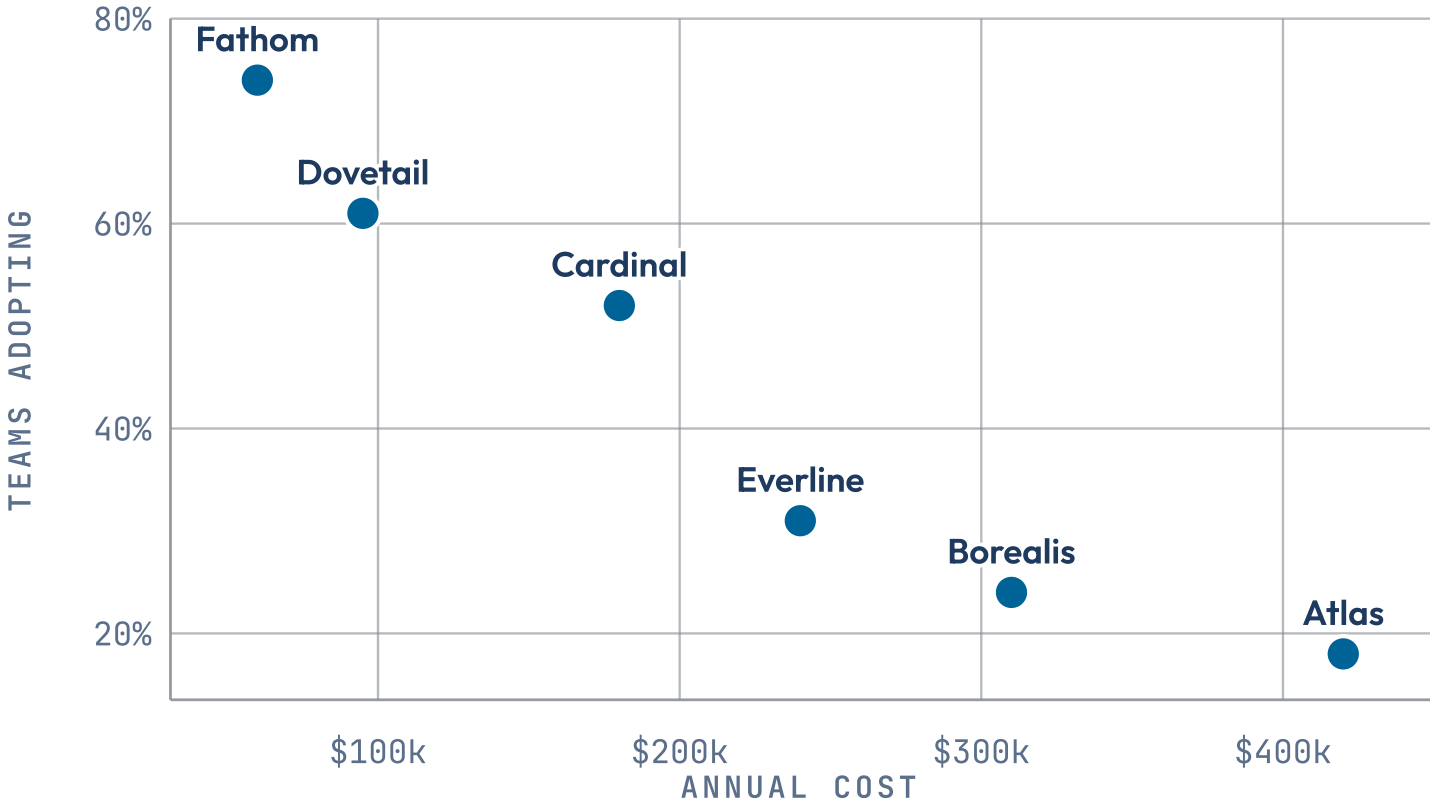
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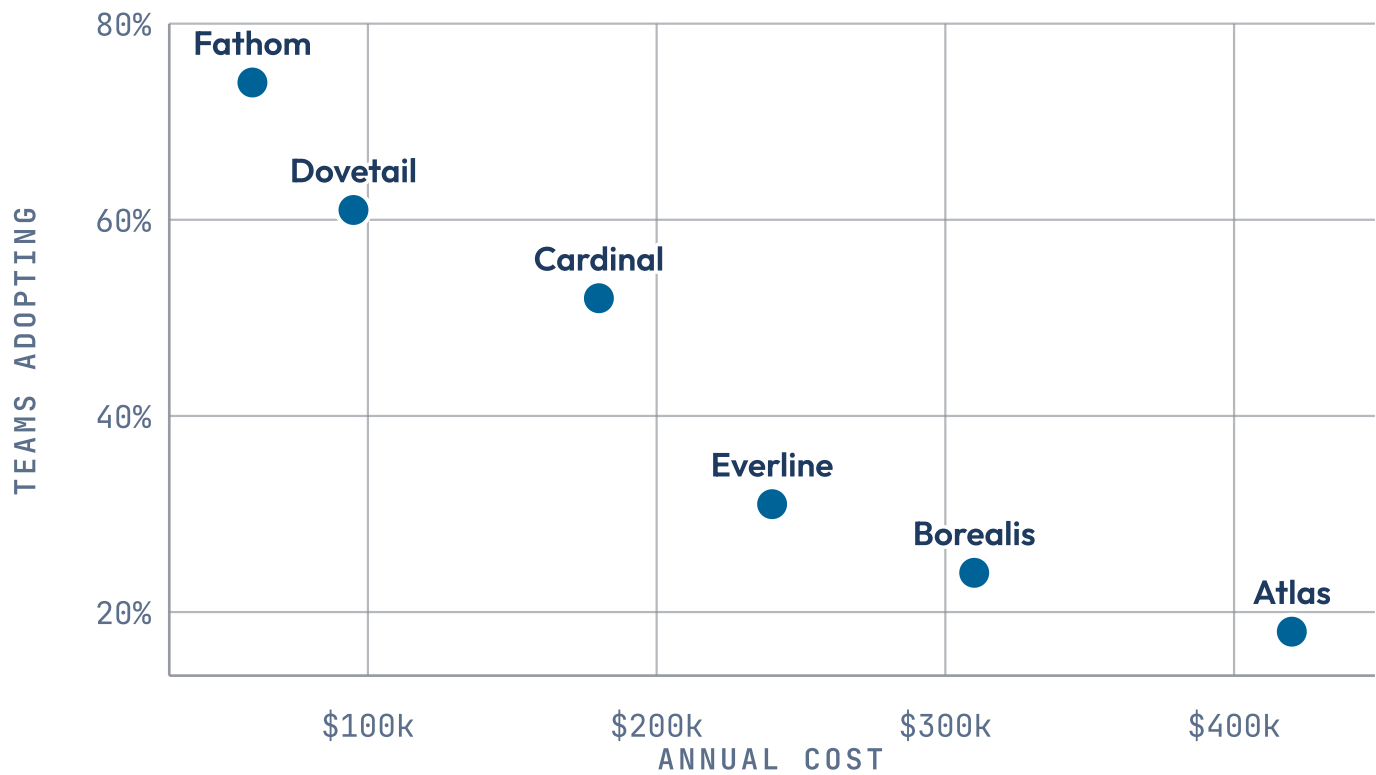
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When NOT to reach for scatter.

A unitless 2x2 score

If the axes are 1-to-10 judgments with no unit, and the read is which of four named zones an item lands in, use `quadrant`. It paints and names the four regions, groups items editorially and colors the dots by group — all things a scatter deliberately does not do, because a real scale has

A trend line over a handful of points

`scatter trend` fits a least-squares line, and under five points it refuses to draw one — a line through four dots is nearly interpolation and asserts a rigor the data has not got. Even at eight, the line says 'these move together', not 'this predicts that'. If the audience will read it as a

Points closer together than the eye can separate

Four tools within four points of each other are four dots inside one dot's width. Nothing in the chart lies — the dots carry a canvas-colored ring so overlap stays visible and no point is jittered off its real position — but the names have to travel and read as a list. If the cluster IS the finding,

Time on the x axis

A series measured at successive dates is a line, not a cloud: the reader needs the connection between consecutive points, which a scatter does not draw. Use `line`.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`quadrant` — the axes are unitless scores and the read is which of four named zones

`matrix-2x2` — items are placed by category, not by coordinate

`radar` — each entity is rated on more than two measures

`progress` — one measure per entity, compared as lengths

`list-tabular` — the exact numbers matter more than the shape of the relationship